Lashkar-e-Taiba commander Zaki-ur-Rehman Lakhvi[26] banned by the UN.[27] The issue surrounding the granting of a visa to Uyghur leader Dolkun Isa (he is a leader of the World Uyghur Congress and lives in Germany) in April 2016 was a clear message to Beijing that India, too, can play around with the definition of terrorism.[28]

Furthermore, while Russia and China have seemingly recognised Pakistan's role in counter-terrorism because of the years of experience it has in fighting terror, India's position has been that Pakistan is a source of terrorism, and India's efforts have been to isolate Pakistan. Whether China will stop ignoring Pakistan-sponsored terrorism against India remains an issue. Therefore, under these conflicting interests on terror, convergence within the SCO could prove problematic.

A change of heart has nonetheless been visible recently. In February 2018, Beijing refused to bail out Pakistan being put on the watch list of the Financial Action Task Force (FATF), the global watchdog on terror financing.[29] India, in turn, supported China's bid for the vice-presidency of the FATF. New Delhi also reciprocated by curtailing the activities of the Dalai Lama. Moreover, Prime Minister Modi avoided flagging the much-touted cross-border terrorism issue at the SCO 2018 Summit in Qingdao as fervently as before. In fact, his low-pitch emphasis on terrorism at the Shangri-La Dialogue held in the run-up to the Qingdao summit was a pointer to this.[30]

At the SCO Qingdao Summit in June 2018, the grouping adopted a "Cooperative Security Treaty" to evolve a sustainable regional security concept, including a three-year (2019–2021) action plan to counter the "three evils" of terrorism, separatism, and religious extremism and setting up a cooperative network of law-enforcement agencies. The Chinese minister of public security, Zhao Kezhi, visited New Delhi a few months later in October to explore new ways to